

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

# Ragozin, Vienna, Tarrasch, and Semi-Tarrasch

Pins, central gambits, isolated pawns, and active-piece solutions

TRAINING WORKBOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

# Workbook Method

Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

## REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

# 01. Ragozin Exchange Structure



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Black's Bb4 adds pressure to c3 before White exchanges on d5, creating an active Carlsbad position with sharper piece play.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. cxd5 exd5 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bh4 c5 8. e3 Nc6 9. Bd3 cxd4 10. exd4 O-O

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Which piece has the least useful job?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- What ending would favor you, and why?  
\_\_\_\_\_

| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

## 02. Ragozin Exchange Structure



### RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

#### POSITION PROMPT

Black's Bb4 adds pressure to c3 before White exchanges on d5, creating an active Carlsbad position with sharper piece play.

#### REFERENCE LINE

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- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 03. Ragozin Exchange Structure



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

POSITION PROMPT

Black's Bb4 adds pressure to c3 before White exchanges on d5, creating an active Carlsbad position with sharper piece play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. cxd5 exd5 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bh4 c5 8. e3 Nc6 9. Bd3 cxd4 10. exd4 O-O

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 04. Ragozin Qa4 Check



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Qa4+ questions the pin immediately and encourages Black to commit the queenside knight before White chooses the structure.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. Qa4+ Nc6 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd2 Re8 8. cxd5 exd5 9. Bd3

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
\_\_\_\_\_
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 05. Ragozin Qa4 Check



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Qa4+ questions the pin immediately and encourages Black to commit the queenside knight before White chooses the structure.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. Qa4+ Nc6 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd2 Re8 8. cxd5 exd5 9. Bd3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 06. Ragozin Qa4 Check



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Qa4+ questions the pin immediately and encourages Black to commit the queenside knight before White chooses the structure.

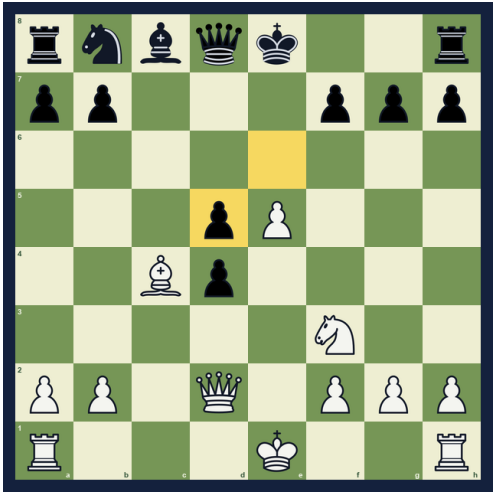
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1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. Qa4+ Nc6 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd2 Re8 8. cxd5 exd5 9. Bd3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 07. Vienna Variation Central Gambit



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Black takes c4 and pins the knight; White builds e4-e5 and accepts tactical complications for space and development.

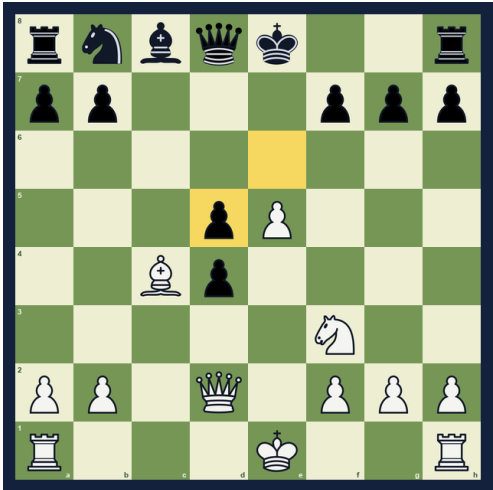
### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. e4 Bb4 6. e5 Nd5 7. Bd2 c5 8. Bxc4 cxd4 9. Nxd5 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 exd5

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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- Which piece has the least useful job?  
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- What ending would favor you, and why?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
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| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 08. Vienna Variation Central Gambit



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Black takes c4 and pins the knight; White builds e4-e5 and accepts tactical complications for space and development.

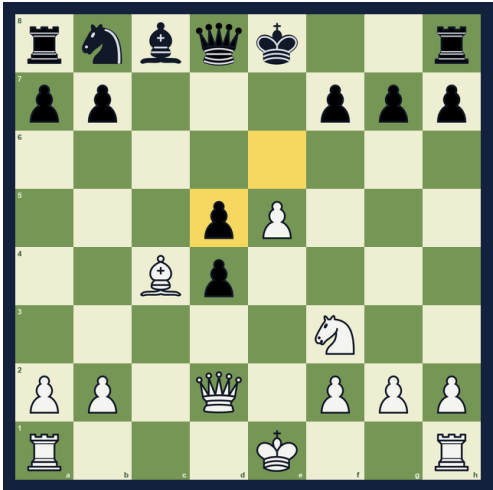
### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. e4 Bb4 6. e5 Nd5 7. Bd2 c5 8. Bxc4 cxd4 9. Nxd5 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 exd5

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 09. Vienna Variation Central Gambit



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Black takes c4 and pins the knight; White builds e4-e5 and accepts tactical complications for space and development.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. e4 Bb4 6. e5 Nd5 7. Bd2 c5 8. Bxc4 cxd4 9. Nxd5 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 exd5

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 10. Tarrasch Defense Main Line



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Black accepts an isolated d-pawn for free development; White uses the fianchetto to pressure the center and reduce Black's activity.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. g3 Nf6 7. Bg2 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. dxc5 Bxc5 10. Bg5

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 11. Tarrasch Defense Main Line



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Black accepts an isolated d-pawn for free development; White uses the fianchetto to pressure the center and reduce Black's activity.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. g3 Nf6 7. Bg2 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. dxc5 Bxc5 10. Bg5

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 12. Tarrasch Defense Main Line



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

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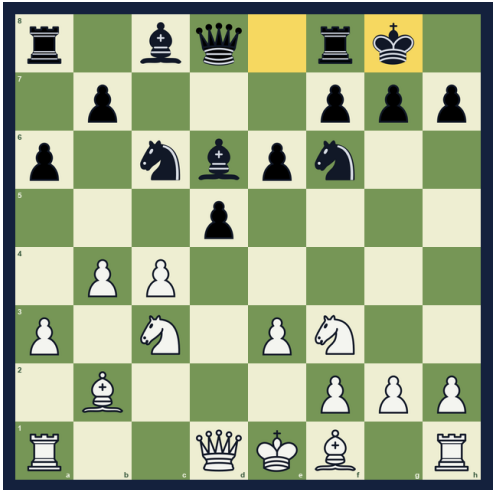
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- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 13. Tarrasch with e3 and a3



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

POSITION PROMPT

White keeps central tension, develops classically, and uses a3-b4 to gain queenside time against Black's active bishop.

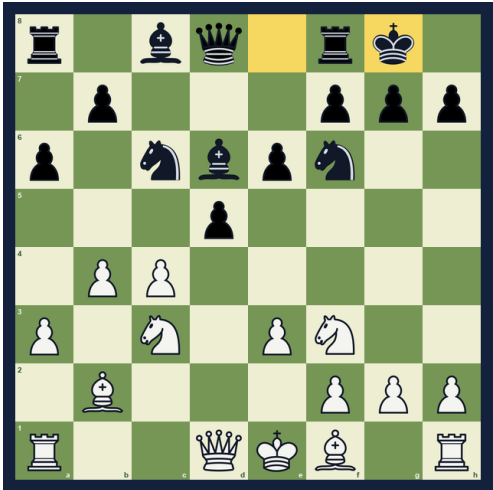
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. e3 Nf6 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. a3 a6 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. b4 Bd6 9. Bb2 O-O

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 14. Tarrasch with e3 and a3



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

POSITION PROMPT

White keeps central tension, develops classically, and uses a3-b4 to gain queenside time against Black's active bishop.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. e3 Nf6 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. a3 a6 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. b4 Bd6 9. Bb2 O-O

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 15. Tarrasch with e3 and a3



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

POSITION PROMPT

White keeps central tension, develops classically, and uses a3-b4 to gain queenside time against Black's active bishop.

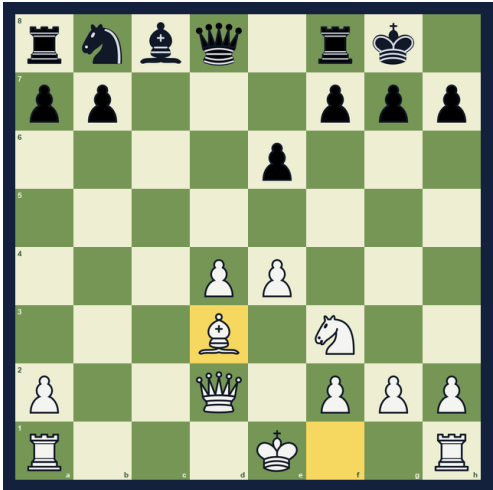
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. e3 Nf6 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. a3 a6 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. b4 Bd6 9. Bb2 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 16. Semi-Tarrasch Main Line



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

POSITION PROMPT

Black recaptures on d5 with a knight, and the forcing exchanges give White a broad center and open bishop pair.

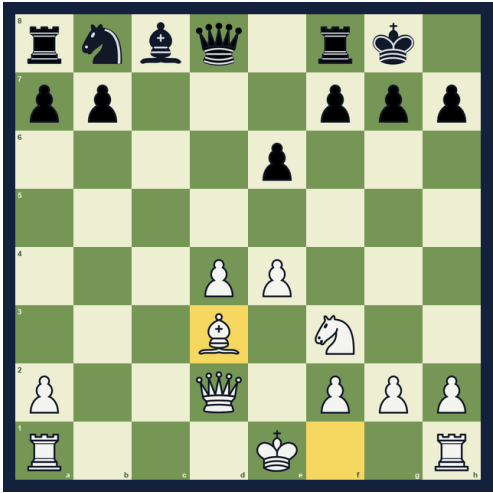
REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e4 Nxc3 7. bxc3 cxd4 8. cxd4 Bb4+ 9. Bd2 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 O-O 11. Bd3

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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- Which piece has the least useful job?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 17. Semi-Tarrasch Main Line



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Black recaptures on d5 with a knight, and the forcing exchanges give White a broad center and open bishop pair.

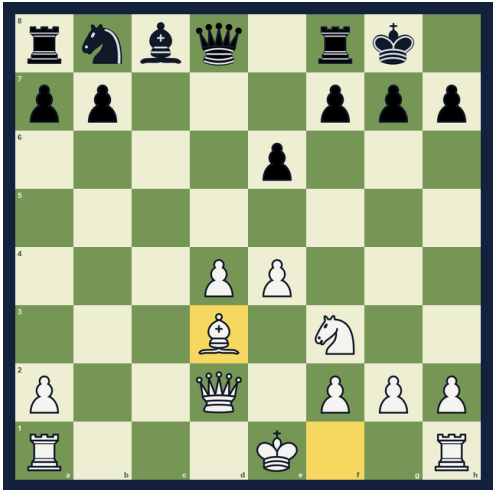
### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e4 Nxc3 7. bxc3 cxd4 8. cxd4 Bb4+ 9. Bd2 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 O-O 11. Bd3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| SELF-SCORE | 0 = guessed   1 = partial   2 = clear rule and best reply |
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 18. Semi-Tarrasch Main Line



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

POSITION PROMPT

Black recaptures on d5 with a knight, and the forcing exchanges give White a broad center and open bishop pair.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e4 Nxc3 7. bxc3 cxd4 8. cxd4 Bb4+ 9. Bd2 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 O-O 11. Bd3

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 19. Ragozin Exchange Structure - Move-Order Lab



RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

POSITION PROMPT

Black's Bb4 adds pressure to c3 before White exchanges on d5, creating an active Carlsbad position with sharper piece play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. cxd5 exd5 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bh4 c5 8. e3 Nc6 9. Bd3 cxd4 10. exd4 O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# 20. Ragozin Exchange Structure - Plan Lab



## RAGOZIN, VIENNA, AND TARRASCH

### POSITION PROMPT

Use development and rooks to prepare the central break.

### REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Bb4 5. cxd5 exd5 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bh4 c5 8. e3 Nc6 9. Bd3 cxd4 10. exd4 O-O

- What does the opponent threaten or improve next?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.  
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- Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?  
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| THREAT     | __ / 2                                                    |
| CANDIDATES | __ / 2                                                    |
| STRUCTURE  | __ / 2                                                    |
| PIECE JOB  | __ / 2                                                    |
| FORECAST   | __ / 2                                                    |

# Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.